

Some years later in 1992, Robert Swan, OBE was the keynote speaker at the first 'World Summit for Sustainable Development' held in Rio de Janeiro. There he addressed world leaders and was charged with undertaking a 10 year global and local environmental mission that would involve industry, business and young people.

Deadline - 2041

2041 is the curious name given to a long term initiative started by Sir Robert Swan, dedicated towards saving the Antarctic. "In the year 2041, the treaty that preserves Antarctica and keeps it from being destroyed, (like we seem to be destroying everywhere else on earth), comes up for review." says Robert Swan. Through his initiative (www.2041.com) he plans to inspire young people who by then will be the people running things like businesses and governments to doing something about the treaty when it comes up for review. "If you look at what is happening in the Arctic today, it shouldn't be allowed to happen in the Antarctic" that was the message Sir Robert is trying to spread. "Wouldn't it just be fabulous for people thousands of

EXCEPTIONAL FEATS

One of the most awe inspiring feats achieved by Sir Robert Swan was the setting up of the world's first renewable energy Education Station in Antarctica, called the E-Base. Since 2003, Swan has led annual expeditions to Antarctica with students and business executives to focus on leadership training, environmental clean-up and education initiatives. The 'Inspire Antarctic Expedition' teams helped design and build the E-Base. In March 2008, Robert Swan, OBE made Antarctic history again by living solely on renewable energy at the E-Base for over two weeks. Successful in the world's harshest climate, the positive message Swan sent to the world was "This is possible in Antarctica, and surely it is possible in the 'real world'!" The E-Base is fully active and fully internet connected at all times. At the time of writing this the station was busy broadcasting the temperature -2°C and wind speed of 9 mph. Head over to <http://ebase.2041.com> for live updates.



"In our own backyards we can take small achievable steps to protect and preserve the beauty and integrity of our environment and our planet for future generations!"

- Robert Swan, OBE

years from today, if we just left one place alone as a natural reserve – a continent for science and peace" he said to us.

Through this initiative he has already taken several humongous steps towards the preservation of the

Antarctic Continent. During his talk, he showed us shocking images of tons and tons of waste dotting the Antarctic landscape. "Rich powerful nations should not leave scientific garbage in a continent we all own". In one of his

expeditions, he assembled a crew of student volunteers from around the globe and successfully removed 1,500 tons of waste from the shores of Antarctica.

What next?

Currently, Sir Robert Swan is a crusader for clean energy and goes to different continents aboard his renewable energy sailboat to spread his message. Not just that. On December 15, 2011, the 25th anniversary of his first expedition to the South Pole, Sir Robert Swan plans to do the 1600km walk to the South Pole all over again. Except this time he will do the journey not using a single drop of fossil fuels. He will be using only renewable sources of energy, making it the world's first polar expedition using only renewable energy. We wish him luck and Godspeed. **d**

